

Lesson 11 & 12:

Argumentative Writing:

Avoiding Substance Use



 In this activity, you will learn how to build a persuasive, evidence-based argument. By the end, you will be able to construct a clear claim and support it with logical reasoning to promote a substance-free lifestyle.



Understand the core concepts

Argumentative writing is a powerful tool to express your values and influence others. By choosing a clear stance and supporting it with facts, you can effectively advocate for healthy habits. Understanding these terms will help you build a stronger essay.

Term	Definition
Claim	A claim is a clear statement of your position on a topic. It serves as the foundation for your entire argument.
Evidence	Evidence is the information or data used to support your claim. This includes scientific facts or reliable statistics.
Counterargument	A counterargument is a viewpoint that opposes your own. Addressing it shows that you have considered other perspectives.



Read these perspectives

Read the following passages carefully to understand different ways to approach this topic. As you read, ask yourself: How does the author use evidence to make their point feel more convincing?

Passage 1: The Power of Choice

Making the decision to remain substance-free is one of the most important steps for long-term health. Science shows that the adolescent brain is still developing, and substances can interrupt this growth. By choosing to stay away from harmful substances, you protect your ability to focus, learn, and excel in your personal goals.

Passage 2: Addressing Peer Pressure

It is common to face pressure to try things that are not good for you. However, standing your ground is a sign of true maturity. When you use logical reasoning to explain why you choose health, you often find that others respect your decision. Real strength lies in knowing what is best for your future.



Building connections between ideas

Now, let's connect the information from the passages to your own thinking. Complete the table below to organize your ideas.

Key Concept	Your Understanding	Why is this important?
Brain Development	<i>Substances can harm the growth of a teenager's brain.</i>	<i>It explains the biological reason to avoid risks.</i>
Peer Pressure		
Healthy Future		
+ Add a row or column as needed		



Try it out

Use what you learned to solve the problems below.

Scenario: A friend invites you to try something you know is harmful. How do you respond?	Write your answer here
What evidence would you use to explain your decision to a peer?	
How would you address a counterargument that says 'everyone is doing it'?	



Show what you learned

Now, create a digital visual project to show your understanding of persuasive techniques. Create a presentation slide that shows what you learned. Use Magic Media or Elements to help visualise or record your idea.

- **Choose** a clear, bold claim about living a healthy life.
- **Include** one piece of scientific evidence from the readings.
- **Add** a rebuttal to a common counterargument.
- **Design** the layout to be clear and persuasive to your peers.

[Double click to design here]



Reflect on your work

Think about the work you have completed so far and answer the following questions.

Identify one clear claim you made in this activity and explain the evidence you used to support it.

[Write your answer here.]

What was the most challenging part of constructing an argument against peer pressure, and why?

How has this activity changed the way you might approach a difficult conversation in the future?